

GIS PROJECT ASSIGNMENT

PRACTICAL

Why Geography Matters: Mapping Strategic Importance of Countries

Project Overview

In this project, you will use GIS tools to analyse the geographical importance of strategic locations around the world.

Your task is to explore how location, resources, trade routes, and physical geography make certain places globally important.

Project Task:

1. Data Collection. Find and use GIS data such as:

- Country boundaries (shapefiles)
- Oil/gas locations
- Rivers, ports, or trade routes
- Population density
- Elevation or terrain

2. Create Maps. Create at least 3–4 maps using QGIS.

- Political map
- Resource map
- Transportation/trade routes
- Population distribution

3. Analysis

- Why is this country/region important?
- What natural resources does it have?
- Does location affect trade or conflict?
- Are there strategic features (ports, borders, chokepoints)?

Important:

Focus on geography, not politics, avoid searching “who is right/wrong”, Data-based reasoning only, use reliable data sources, keep maps clear and readable and All group members must participate

Be prepared with the presentation on **2nd April 2026**. Presentation Guidelines are as follows.

1. Present your topic clearly by first introducing the location and showing a simple map.
2. Briefly explain what data you used and how you created your maps.
3. Show your maps and describe the main patterns or important features.
4. Explain why the location is geographically important using your findings.
5. Make sure all group members speak and keep your presentation within the time limit.

Topics

1. Importance of the Suez Canal Region
2. Oil Distribution in Saudi Arabia
3. Strategic Location of the Strait of Hormuz
4. Population vs Resources in Israel & Palestine
5. Trade Routes through the Red Sea
6. Strategic Importance of the Panama Canal
7. Strategic Location of Singapore & the Strait of Malacca
8. Importance of Diego Garcia (Indian Ocean)
9. Water Resources in the Nile River Basin
10. Arctic Region: Emerging Shipping Routes & Resources